



A WORDS HAVE WEATHER STORY EBOOK

Leo and the Question That Wouldn't Start

Knowing is not the same as being ready to speak



THE HOOK

Every answer

Leo knew every answer - except how to raise his hand. In his head, the words were lined up and ready. At his elbow, they disappeared.



THE PRESSURE LINE

Everyone else

Ms Chen waited, then said, "Everyone else has shared. Leo, you need to join in." Twenty-four eyes seemed to turn at once.



POSSIBLE WORD-WEATHER

The fog arrives

Pale fog filled the space between Leo and the class. Willo listened beside the desk. "More eyes may make the answer harder to reach," Willo said.



PRIVATE REPAIR

A smaller room

At recess, Ms Chen chose the quiet side table. "I put you on display. I am sorry. The learning still matters, and we need a better way to show it."



THREE ROUTES

Say, write or pass

"Next time, you can say the idea, write it on a card, or pass and come back later. Which should we try first?"



THE CARD

The question begins

Leo chose a card. He wrote one sentence. Zahra kept working beside him without reading over his shoulder.



PARTICIPATION

Visible in a new way

Leo placed the card on the class board himself. Ms Chen nodded and kept teaching. No spotlight. No cheer. The idea had arrived.



READ IT AGAIN

What was the goal?

The goal was not a raised hand. The goal was for Leo to take part in thinking and sharing. Once the route changed, the learning could stay.



TRY IT TOGETHER

Participation menu

Build a class menu: speak, point, write, draw, pair-share or pass-and-return. Ask which routes still show the learning goal and when safety or assessment rules narrow the choices.



WILLO WONDERS

Who needed the repair?

Leo did not need to apologise for the fog. Ms Chen repaired the public pressure and changed the participation design.

Adult notes

Key message: preserve the learning goal while widening legitimate ways to participate. Try: (1) co-design a participation menu; (2) sort tasks by the skill being assessed; (3) practise a private repair after public pressure. Do not diagnose silence from one story. Follow documented adjustments, consult the learner and relevant support people, and keep safeguarding or safety instructions clear.

